

Will McGowan

9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

Winton

Grove House, 27 Hammersmith Grove

London W6 ONE

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Quantitative Researcher – Graduate: 2027 role in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Winton's focus on statistical inference in financial markets describes the work I most enjoy, and its trend-following research is close to the forecasting and backtesting I do myself.

My work keeps returning to one question: does an apparent edge survive a proper test? I tested CAPM on 704 anomaly portfolios across 56 countries and rejected zero alpha jointly in 48 of 52, with momentum the most persistent anomaly. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, forecasts European gas volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models built on storage, market and news-based data, evaluates them out-of-sample against HAR and AR benchmarks, and asks whether better forecasts improve a volatility-targeted TTF futures strategy. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, I also built a wheat calendar-spread strategy whose weekly backtest returned a Sharpe ratio of 0.76 before costs and 0.28 after, which taught me how quickly turnover erodes an edge.

Hedge funds appeal to me because the distance between an idea and its consequences is short: a research view becomes a position, and the position is marked every day. I take that accountability seriously. My lifetime poker winnings of over £40,000 came from respecting variance and sizing risk to a strict 50-buy-in bankroll rule, and as Treasurer of the Agricapital Society, which I helped grow to 126 members, I manage its budget and accounts.

Winton stands out to me because it has built its business on statistical inference rather than narrative, and it keeps extending that research into new formats, bringing its flagship major-market trend strategy to a US mutual fund for the first time in October 2025. Benchmarking my gas volatility models out-of-sample with Diebold-Mariano tests, across pre-crisis, crisis and post-crisis periods, has taught me to distrust any result that has not survived unseen data, which I understand is the standard Winton's researchers work to.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan